

Instructor Guide: Build a Service Package

Metadata

Field	Detail
Path	Digital Independence Path
Course	17 — Skills That Pay
Lesson	3 of course — Build a Service Package
Age range	15–18
Format	Live, instructor-led
Duration	60 minutes
Tools	Google Docs, Canva, Notion, Email, Spreadsheets
Prerequisite	Lesson 2: student has already chosen one service to offer (e.g. logo design, tutoring, social media graphics, simple websites, video editing, pet sitting flyers, resume formatting)
Lesson output	A one-page "Service Package" document for the student's chosen service, built in Google Docs or Canva

Overview

In Lesson 2, students picked one service they could realistically offer. Today they turn that idea into something a real customer could say yes to: a clear, written package. The core skill is **scope clarity** — spelling out exactly what is included, what is not, how the work will be delivered, how long it will take, and what happens if the customer wants changes. This is the single most common gap between beginner freelancers and people who get repeat clients: beginners either promise too much (leading to burnout and resentment) or say too little (leading to disputes about what was "supposed" to happen).

This lesson deliberately keeps things simple: **one tier only**. Multi-tier pricing (basic/standard/premium) is a Course 17 topic for a later lesson, once students already know how to define a single clean scope. Introducing tiers here would let students dodge the harder skill of drawing a firm line around one offer.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to: 1. Explain why "included" and "not included" lists prevent conflict with customers. 2. Write a specific, non-vague deliverable description (format, quantity, and detail). 3. Set a realistic

turnaround time. 4. Write a bounded revision policy that protects their time without sounding unfriendly. 5. Produce a complete one-page service package document for their own chosen service.

Prep (Before Class)

- Confirm each student's Lesson 2 service choice; have the list ready to reference by name during the demo and check-ins.
- Open a blank Google Doc (or Canva doc template) to demo live. Do not pre-fill it — students should watch it get built from a blank page, including the messy first draft.
- Have the Worksheet.md printed or shared digitally (Notion or Google Docs) for every student.
- Test screen share and confirm all students can access Docs/Canva/Notion/Spreadsheets/Email as needed.
- Optional: have one real-world example (a screenshot of an Etsy or Fiverr service listing) ready to show as a "what a package looks like in the wild" reference — anonymize or use a generic public listing, not a specific person's business.

Materials Checklist

- ☐ Slide or whiteboard: the four package components (Included / Not Included / Deliverable Format / Turnaround / Revision Policy — five, matching the worksheet)
- ☐ Blank Google Doc for live demo
- ☐ Worksheet.md shared with each student
- ☐ List of student service choices from Lesson 2

Teaching Sequence

1. Opening hook (5 min)

Ask: "Has anyone ever ordered food and it came without something you assumed was included — like fries, or a drink?" Take one or two answers. Point out: the restaurant didn't lie, but the menu wasn't clear enough, and now someone's annoyed. That mismatch between what a customer *expects* and what they *actually get* is exactly what a service package prevents. Today's job: write down, in plain words, exactly what a customer gets when they hire you.

2. Why scope clarity matters (10 min)

Direct instruction + discussion. Cover: - A **service package** is a short written description of exactly what someone gets when they pay for your service. - The two most common beginner mistakes are (a) being vague ("I'll make you a nice website") and (b) promising too much ("unlimited revisions until you're happy"). - Walk through the "included / not included" idea: listing what's *not* included isn't rude — it's protective, for both sides. Example: a tutoring package might include "one 45-minute session, practice worksheet emailed after" but *not* include "homework grading" or "sessions on weekends." Neither side gets surprised later. - Emphasize: **the package is a promise you can**

actually keep. If it's unclear, disagreements happen after the work is already done — which is the worst time, because trust is already broken and no one wants to redo it for free.

Talking point script (use close to verbatim if helpful):

"The goal of a service package is not to sound impressive. It's to make sure that if you and your customer never spoke again after this document, you'd both agree on what was owed. That's the test: could a stranger read this and know exactly what they get, and exactly what they don't?"

3. Live demo — building a fictional package (15 min)

Build this live in the shared Google Doc, narrating each decision out loud, including the ones you cross out or revise.

Fictional student: "Maya," service: Instagram post graphics for small local businesses.

Narrate the build in this order: 1. **Service Name** — "Maya's Post Graphics" — short and specific, not "social media services" (too vague). 2. **Deliverable Format** — decide out loud: "3 finished Instagram post graphics (1080x1080px), delivered as PNG files by email." Point out: file format and dimensions matter — a customer who expected a Canva template link and got a flat PNG will be unhappy, even though Maya technically delivered "graphics." 3. **What's Included** — bullet it live: - 3 custom graphics based on the business's colors/logo - Text and business name added to each graphic - Files delivered as PNG, sized for Instagram feed posts 4. **What's Not Included** — bullet it live, and explain each choice: - Posting the graphics to Instagram (Maya isn't managing their account) - Video or Reels content (different skill, different service) - Additional graphics beyond the 3 (that's a new order) 5. **Turnaround Time** — "3 business days from when I receive the business's logo and color preferences." Point out: turnaround should start from when the customer gives Maya what she needs, not from the moment they pay — otherwise Maya is on the hook for delays that aren't her fault. 6. **Revision Policy** — "Up to 1 round of revisions included (example: adjusting text or colors). Additional rounds are a new small fee." Contrast this with "unlimited revisions" and ask the group why that phrase is a trap (see misconceptions below) before writing the bounded version.

End the demo by reading the whole one-pager aloud as if you were the customer, checking: "Does this answer every question I'd have before paying?"

4. Discussion questions (5 min)

Pose to the group, cold-call or thumbs-up/down first: - "If Maya's package didn't mention turnaround time, what could go wrong?" - "Why might listing 'what's not included' actually help Maya get *more* repeat customers, not fewer?" - "What's the risk if Maya offers unlimited revisions?" - "Could two different customers read this package and expect two different things? If yes, what's still unclear?"

5. Guided student activity (20 min)

Students open the Worksheet and build their own package for their Lesson 2 service, using Google Docs, Canva, or Notion (whichever the student prefers or was assigned). - First 3 minutes: students silently draft their Deliverable Format and Included list only — don't let them fill the whole sheet at once. - Circulate (or use breakout rooms) and check every student's Deliverable Format line before they move on — this is the field most likely to be too vague. -

Remaining time: students complete Not Included, Turnaround, and Revision Policy. - Early finishers: have them trade documents with a partner and try to find one sentence that's still vague enough to cause a misunderstanding.

6. Lesson close (5 min)

- Cold-call 2–3 students to read just their "Not Included" list aloud — this is usually the most revealing field and a good gauge of understanding.
- Recap the core rule: **a good package answers every question a customer would have, before they ask it.**
- State submission instructions (see Student_Lesson.md) and preview Lesson 4 (which will build on this package, e.g. pricing or the customer-facing offer message).

Common Misconceptions to Address

- **"More included = a better deal."** Push back directly: a package that includes too much is a package the student can't actually deliver reliably, and it trains customers to expect endless extras for free. A tight, honest package that's delivered well beats an overloaded one that burns the student out or gets delivered late.
- **"I should offer unlimited revisions to seem generous."** This is the single most common trap. Unlimited revisions means unlimited unpaid time, and it removes the customer's incentive to give clear feedback the first time. Bounded revisions (e.g. "1 round included") protect the student's time and, ironically, usually produce *faster* results for the customer because it forces clearer communication upfront.
- **"If I write down what's not included, it sounds negative or unfriendly."** Reframe: it reads as professional and protects the relationship — it's the same reason a syllabus lists what's not on a test.
- **"The deliverable format doesn't matter much — the customer will figure it out."** Push back: format (file type, size, quantity, delivery method) is often exactly where mismatches happen.

Anticipated Student Difficulties

- **Vague deliverables.** Students often write things like "a good website" instead of "a 1-page website with 3 sections (About, Services, Contact), delivered as a link to a live page." Prompt with: "If I couldn't ask you a single follow-up question, would I know exactly what I'm getting?"
- **Copying the demo too literally.** Some students may just swap in their service name without adjusting content. Ask each student one specific question about their own service to check real understanding (e.g., "What's the biggest thing that could go wrong if a customer assumed X was included?").
- **Turnaround time with no starting point.** Students may write "3 days" without saying 3 days from what. Prompt: "3 days starting when?"
- **Revision policy that's either 0 or unlimited.** Guide students toward a small, defined number (0–2 rounds) rather than either extreme.

Troubleshooting

- **Student can't decide what to exclude:** Ask, "What would take you the most extra time or skill that isn't part of the core service?" That's usually the exclusion.
- **Student's package is too long/complicated:** Remind them this is a first, single-tier package — simpler is better; multi-tier options come in a later lesson.
- **Tool trouble (Docs/Canva access):** Have a Notion or plain-email fallback ready — the content matters more than the tool.
- **Student finishes early and has spare time:** Have them read their package aloud to a partner and ask the partner to try to "misunderstand" it on purpose — a good stress test.

How to Review Student Work

Check each submitted package against this quick rubric: 1. Deliverable format is specific (quantity, file type/format, and how it's delivered are all named). 2. At least 2 items are listed as "not included," and they are plausible exclusions for that service (not random). 3. Turnaround time includes a clear starting point. 4. Revision policy is bounded (a specific number of rounds), not "unlimited" and not "none mentioned." 5. Overall: could a stranger read it and know exactly what they get?

Give specific feedback on the field that's weakest rather than general praise — most students will need feedback on exactly one field (usually deliverable format or revision policy).

Lesson Close / Bridge to Next Lesson

End by naming what comes next: this package is the foundation for how the student will describe their service to a real customer (Lesson 4). Remind students to save their document somewhere they can find it again — they'll build directly on top of it.